

The Goldman Sachs Internal Audit job simulation gave me a chance to learn about a side of banking that I have not really worked in before. I completed an accounting internship at WebBank and now work there part time as an Accounting Analyst while finishing school at Rutgers. I have worked on bank reconciliations, month-end close procedures, and other accounting tasks, but I have not done internal audit. That is why this simulation was interesting to me. It was related to the work I already do, but it made me look at things differently. I had to think about what could go wrong with a process and how the bank could catch or prevent those problems.

One of the first things I took away was that internal audit is more than just checking someone's work for mistakes. Auditors also need to understand how the work gets done and whether the checks in place actually work. The knowledge checks covered attention to detail, ethical judgment, working with other teams, and thinking about risk. These are all things that matter in accounting too. The difference is that an auditor has to look beyond one task. For example, when reviewing a reconciliation, it is important to find a difference, but it also matters whether the same problem could keep happening. I started to understand why someone needs to step back and look at the process as a whole.

The student risk assessment was a good way to start because it connected the idea of risk to my own life. I focused on managing a study schedule, which is something I have to think about while balancing classes and work. Some of the risks were putting assignments off, getting distracted, losing files, and not giving myself enough time to study. I looked at how likely each problem was and how much it could affect me, then used the risk matrix to find its rating. Something like losing a file might not happen often, but it could still cause a big problem if an assignment was due that night.

I liked that the assessment also required a plan for dealing with each risk. It is easy to say that I need to manage my time better, but that does not really explain what I am going to change. Planning study time, setting a deadline before the actual due date, and keeping backups of my work are more useful because they are specific things I can do. With school and a part-time job, I sometimes have several responsibilities that need my attention at once. This activity made me think more about preparing for those busy weeks ahead of time instead of only focusing on whichever assignment is due next.

The first banking scenario focused on trade execution delays. There were 150 trades with discrepancies out of 2,000, which came out to 7.5%. The average execution time was five seconds compared to the three-second industry standard given in the scenario. At first, a two-second difference did not seem that large, but the estimated loss was \$500,000. That put the issue into perspective for me. A small delay can mean a lot when money and market prices are involved. It could also upset clients who expect their trades to be completed on time. Before deciding how to fix it, I would want to look at the records and understand where those delays were happening. The corporate lending scenario was the one I connected with most because of my experience at WebBank. During my internship, I worked with multiple partners to help ensure the accuracy of loan, collateral, and fee distributions. This scenario dealt with loans too, but the focus was on whether clients could repay them. The percentage of non-performing loans increased from 4.5% to 7.5%, and mid-sized companies made up most of those problem loans. It

was interesting to look at loans from that side. In accounting, I have worked on making sure information is accurate, but a loan being recorded correctly does not mean the borrower will be able to pay it back.

For that scenario, I recommended more frequent monitoring after a loan is approved. The bank should keep checking payment history and the borrower's financial situation instead of assuming everything is fine once the loan goes through. If a company starts struggling, noticing it earlier could give the bank and the client more time to figure out what to do. I also thought it was important not to immediately blame the people who approved the loans. A company's situation can change after approval, so the auditor would need to look into what happened. Better reviews could help the bank avoid losses and help clients receive loans that make sense for their situation.

The anti-money laundering scenario focused on suspicious transactions and employee training. Only 30 out of 50 suspicious transactions had been reported, and only 800 out of 1,200 employees had completed training. The part that stood out most was that previous audits had already found problems, but there had not been much improvement. Finding the same issues again would make me question whether anyone was making sure they got fixed. I would want to understand why the transactions were not reported and whether employees knew what they were supposed to do. Giving someone responsibility for each issue, setting deadlines, and checking back would help make sure the recommendations actually led to changes.

Another part of the simulation that connected to my job was working with other teams. Internal Audit needs information from people in areas such as Risk, Compliance, and Technology to understand what is happening. This made sense to me because accounting work also involves communicating with other people to resolve questions or differences. Looking at numbers alone does not always give you the full answer. Sometimes you need someone to explain how something was processed or why it was done a certain way. An auditor needs to be willing to ask those questions while still looking at the facts fairly. I think that is a skill that would be useful in any accounting role.

The calculations in the simulation were fairly straightforward, but explaining what they meant took more thought. Knowing that 7.5% of trades had discrepancies was only part of the answer. I also had to think about how that affected the bank and its clients and what could be done about it. That is something I want to keep getting better at in my own work. I do not want to only know that two amounts do not match. I want to understand why there is a difference and be able to explain it. The simulation gave me practice going a step further and thinking about what the information was actually telling me.

Overall, I thought this simulation was useful because it introduced me to the other side of work I already have some experience with. I have been involved in accounting operations, but I had not really looked at those processes from an internal auditor's point of view. I now understand more about why reviews, documentation, and following up on problems matter. It also reminded me that asking questions is important, especially when I am still learning. As I continue working at WebBank and studying accounting at Rutgers, I can pay more attention to why certain checks are done and what they help prevent. I would still have a lot to learn about audit, but this was a good way to get a better idea of what the work involves.